

Data Classification and Handling Policy

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The handling of sensitive information is an essential aspect of maintaining confidentiality, security, and compliance within our organization. To achieve this, we have established a tiered classification system for data, which categorizes it into public, internal, confidential, and restricted tiers. Public-tier data refers to information that can be freely shared without any restrictions, such as company announcements or publicly available financial reports. Internal-tier data includes information that is relevant to employees but not sensitive enough to warrant confidentiality, like employee directories or company newsletters.

Confidential-tier data, on the other hand, contains sensitive information that requires careful handling and protection, such as customer personal data or proprietary business strategies. Restricted-tier data falls under this category and may include highly sensitive information that could compromise our competitive advantage or put individuals at risk if disclosed improperly. As described under the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Policy, employees are expected to disclose any potential conflicts of interest when dealing with restricted-tier data.

When handling restricted-tier data, it is essential to follow strict guidelines to ensure its confidentiality and security. This includes never transmitting such data over unencrypted channels, as required by our organization's Anti-Harassment and Workplace Conduct Policy, which emphasizes the importance of maintaining a safe and respectful work environment. Furthermore, employees are expected to use secure communication channels, such as encrypted email or messaging platforms, when sharing restricted-tier data with colleagues or external parties.

In addition to these guidelines, employees must also be mindful of their personal conduct when handling sensitive information. As stated under the Anti-Harassment and Workplace Conduct Policy, any form of harassment or misconduct related to data handling will not be tolerated and may result in disciplinary action. By following this policy and adhering to our Data Classification and Handling Policy, we can ensure that our organization maintains a culture of trust, respect, and confidentiality when dealing with sensitive information.